



Canon EOS 850D

Canon has launched the 21.4 megapixel EOS 850 D with a dual pixel sensor, and 4K video recording. <https://digit.in/apr20-45>



The Dualshock legacy

Sony is changing the tech for haptic feedback in its controllers, here is a look at the legacy of the original. <https://digit.in/apr20-46>

Cloudwalker 55-inch 4K TV

Another budget AOSP smart TV



Price
₹38,990

We have seen the launch of a number of TVs in India in the budget segment sporting Android TV and not AOSP. With the upgrade from AOSP to Android TV in the budget segment, the UI and UX have improved greatly. However, there are still some TVs running on AOSP and trying to give users a different user experience. Today we have with us a Smart LED Screen from Cloudwalker. The unique thing is that the TV comes with a keyboard and mouse in the box, runs on AOSP and has a customised home screen. Is it enough to make a difference?

Build and Design

The TV has an all-plastic shell, plastic feet that are slim and bezels that surround the display. When kept on a tabletop, there is a little less than 5-inches of space below the TV, which should be enough for a slim soundbar and your set-top-box.

When it comes to connectivity, the Cloudwalker Smart LED screen has three HDMI ports and two USB ports on the side including ARC support on HDMI 3. At the back, you have a LAN port, optical audio port, two component-in ports, and an earphones port.

Apart from the remote control, you also get a wireless keyboard and mouse.



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The remote control is standard, what you'd expect from a budget TV. You have the playback

controls, settings buttons, navigation buttons, channel and volume rocker and a number pad. Overall, though functional the remote isn't ergonomic.

Moving to the keyboard and mouse, they are

compact and run on two AAA batteries each. They connect to the TV via a USB dongle, so know that one of the two USB ports of the TV will be consumed. The keyboard and mouse are made of plastic, are light and feel really cheap. The keyboard has a slight incline making it convenient to type on but the mouse is barebones basic. For basic navigation and typing, it gets the job done.

Performance

The display on the CloudWalker 55-inch 4K TV is a 4K panel with support for HDR 10. Since the TV runs on AOSP, none of the built-in apps we tried supported 4K and HDR content. So we resorted to our trusty XBOX One X. We watched shows like Our Planet, Grand Tour, Altered Carbon and more from our test catalogue and the output was slightly darker than we'd like with the HDR switched on. Switching off HDR made the colours look washed out. Overall, despite boasting of HDR, only

limited content on the TV looks good in this setting. The TV is also pretty loud, even at 45 percent volume and that is a good thing. It doesn't crackle until you turn it up quite a bit, close to about 80 percent or higher.

You can access social networking websites and type documents on the TV. The UI was laggy and on multiple occasions, apps crashed. Apart from some social networking and typing, we don't see this TV being used to make PPTs or multitasking like you would on a PC.

For the rest of the UI, the content is well divided into rows highlighting content from various streaming services. This layout of the UI is good as it exposes you to content first, and the app second. The UI was responsive and worked well. Even streaming services like Hotstar and others worked just fine. If Netflix and Prime Videos are not your primary source of streaming then you can actually be happy with the UI and streaming capabilities of this TV.

Bottom Line

At the 30K price point, there are a lot of 55-inch TVs to choose from brands like Kodak, Shincor, iFALCON and more. In fact, if you go for 50-inches instead of 55, you have some TVs running on the Android TV platform. Going up a notch, close to the 35k price point, we have 55-inch TVs from manufacturers like Xiaomi, TCL and more giving you voice controls from the remote control and Netflix, Prime Videos, Android TV and better picture quality out of the box. But, as we said, that's a premium of 5k. If you have a budget of 30k, we recommend you take a look at other offerings before making your purchase decision.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 55-inch (also available in 43 and 65-inch options) | PANEL TYPE: IPS | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: No | HDMI PORTS: 3 | USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH: No | WI-FI: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | SPEAKERS: 2x10W | CPU: Dual-Core A73 ARM Cortex Processor | GPU: Quad-Core Mali 450 Graphic Processor | RAM: 1GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 8GB | OS: Android 7 (AOSP)

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